Fw: Observation Notes

Benjamin Pacini
Brigham Young University - Idaho
Teacher Education Faculty - HIN 249
Cell: (801) 618-7865
Zoom: 899-634-5818

"Believe There Is Good In The World"

Book time to meet with me

From: Ashcraft, Carol <ashcraftc@byui.edu>
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To: Pacini, Benjamin <pacinib@byui.edu>
Subject: Observation Notes

It was great to be in your class today!
Looking over my notes from today, I have a few comments and questions (below). I'd be happy to meet up for a "debrief" or if you want to just email me a response that works fine too.

1) When you ask students on Zoom to be in an academic setting, do they know what you mean by that? We've all taught on Zoom in the past year, and there always seems to be students who insist on their camera being off or are visibly in bed or otherwise distracted. What have you done in the past to help them understand an "academic setting"?
2) In class, you shared a conference quote, memes, and inspirational words surrounding social media in addition to what was the day's lesson. Is there a connection between these (seeming) tangents and the lesson? I have some ideas but I want to hear your purpose.
3) I loved the Routines and Procedures activity for a few reasons. a) It's been awhile since 7th grade for all of us and it is invaluable as an educator to remember how that age felt for you. b) Actually getting out of the classroom and committing to the role of a 7th grader makes for an unforgettable moment. c) I loved the discussion that followed. I remember a professor saying that "Behaviorism is education's version of Lucifer's plan" when I went to BYUI. I think you made it clear that Behaviorism does have a place in our classrooms, not to CONTROL behavior but to, as you put it, "Make behaving the right choice, and make it the cool thing to do."
4) You had a simple re-phrase that was meaningful to me. In my classes I say "any questions" or "how do you feel about this…" A LOT. You asked "What else is powerful about this activity?" Just the use of that adjective makes a big difference. Something I'll implement in the future. A few minutes later you said "I'm gonna give you 30 more seconds to think about any questions you have" I could tell from how you said it that that is a common practice which exemplifies establishing routine and expectations.
5) Teaching groups: . I really appreciate when you said to me, "We talk about teaching but we don't give them opportunities to teach." I'm sure I am not alone in feeling that way about my own educational training! That principle correlates well with the "Come follow me" program for youth and for adults.

Thanks again for the opportunity and it was nice to meet you!

- Carol Ashcraft